

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Winter storm

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Stay indoors and postpone travel during dangerous snow, ice or blowing snow. Keep heat safe, use battery lighting and watch for power loss. If stranded in a vehicle, stay with it unless a safer shelter is clearly accessible.

Do now.

☐**Check road conditions**

01

Use official closures and forecasts before deciding to travel.

☐**Keep warmth safe**

02

Wear dry layers; never heat a home with an oven, grill or indoor generator.

☐**Prepare for outages**

03

Keep essential medicines, water, food, light and charged batteries accessible.

☐**If stranded**

04

Call for help with your location. If running the engine briefly for heat, first clear snow from the exhaust and crack a window; monitor for carbon monoxide.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Keep dry layers, safe food, water and battery light together. If stranded in a vehicle, keep the exhaust clear before running the engine and conserve fuel; do not sleep with the engine running. Remain with the vehicle when walking would expose you to poor visibility or severe cold.

Watch for.

Do not walk away from a stranded vehicle in poor visibility unless you know a safe nearby destination.

People & practical needs.

Account for children, older people, pets and anyone who needs assistance before moving. Keep shoes, medicines and a torch in the shelter area

Next decision.

Check on people who rely on powered equipment or may lack safe heat. Arrange relocation before indoor temperatures become dangerous.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Winter storm · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/winter-storm/>